

Empathy Map

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User Persona: Loan Applicant

Says

- "I just want to know if I'm eligible before going through the full process."
- "Why was my friend approved but I wasn't, even though our situations look similar?"

Thinks

- "Is my income enough?"
- "Will my credit history work against me?"
- "I wish there was a quick way to check without paperwork."

Does

- Fills long physical/online forms with personal and financial details.
- Visits the bank branch multiple times for status updates.
- Asks friends/family about their own loan approval experiences for reference.

Feels

- Anxious about the uncertainty of approval.
- Frustrated by long waiting periods.
- Relieved when given a fast, clear answer.

User Persona: Loan Officer

Says / Thinks

- "I have dozens of applications to review today."
- "I need a reliable first-pass filter so I can focus on edge cases."

Pain Points

- Manual cross-verification of income, credit history, and employment status.
- Risk of inconsistent decisions across different officers.

Gains Expected from Smart Lender

- An instant, data-backed eligibility prediction to support (not replace) their judgment.

- Reduced manual workload for straightforward cases.